

LICENSE PLATE READERS (LPR)		
	DEPARTMENT SOP: 228.1	CALEA:
	EFFECTIVE DATE:	CFA:
	REVIEW: 08/13/2013	

PURPOSE: To establish criteria for the deployment of mobile License Plate Readers (LPR)

SCOPE: This SOP applies to all Sworn Members assigned a License Plate Reader.

POLICY: It is the policy of the Hollywood Police Department to utilize the latest technology to support the law enforcement function in the identification and apprehension of criminals. License Plate Readers (LPR) utilize computer technology to scan and identify vehicle license plate numbers and letters, which appear on selected Hot Lists.

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PROCEDURE:

I. DEPLOYMENT

A. Contributing Factors for Deployment:

The Deployment of LPR's is based upon the following factors:

1. The Patrol Division Major will be responsible for selecting Officers for LPR assignment.
2. LPR's will be assigned to Patrol Division Officers and/or Detectives.

B. Deployment Authority:

Deployment responsibility.

1. The Patrol, Special Operations Section, Traffic Lieutenant will be the liaison with the LPR provider.
2. The Police Operations Technician is the designated System Administrator.

II. OFFICER RESPONSIBILITIES

A. Requirements:

The following is required for each Officer assigned an LPR:

1. Officers will ensure that the LPR is in good working order at the beginning of each tour of duty. Any system malfunctions will be reported to the Traffic Lieutenant.
2. Officers will conduct a daily download of Hot List files from the NCIC / FCIC website at the start of their tour of duty.
3. Officers will ensure the LPR is operational at all times while operating their assigned Police vehicle during their tour of duty.
4. Officers will utilize the LPR for Law Enforcement purposes only.

B. Accountability:

Each Officer assigned an LPR system is responsible for the following:

1. Officers will complete an LPR Alert Log in circumstances where the LPR system is responsible for the recovery of person(s), property, arrests or agency generated Hot List alerts, to include:
 - a. Amber Alert
 - b. Silver Alert
 - c. Stolen Tag
 - d. Stolen Vehicle
 - e. Terrorist Watch List wanted person.
 - f. Felony Vehicle/Wanted Person
2. Officers assigned the LPR will forward the Alert Log, on a quarterly basis beginning January 1st each year, to the Traffic Lieutenant.
3. Agency Generated Hot Lists, will include:
 - a. Documented gang member vehicles.

- b. Robbery/Burglary suspects and arrestee vehicles.
 - c. Locally wanted persons.
 - d. Suspect vehicles identified by Agency Crime Analysts for dissemination to Officers.
 - e. Any other entry requires supervisory approval from the Investigative Services Section Lieutenant or the Traffic Lieutenant.
4. Agency Generated Hot List entries will be entered on an excel spreadsheet located on a secure drive. The Investigative Services Section or Patrol Division Analysts will complete the entries. These entries automatically upload to the secure server. The following information is needed:
 - a. License Plate numbers/letters.
 - b. License Plate State.
 - c. Alarm class of either:
 1. "00 Alarm"
 2. "09 Other"
 - d. Notes: pertinent information up to 100 characters explaining the entry.

C. Hot List Alerts:

- a. During operation, LPR alerts are indicated by an audible and visual alarm.
- b. An audible / visual alarm shall not be a basis for a traffic stop or arrest.
- c. In cases of NCIC/FCIC alerts, Officers will verify the tag information via Police radio to Communications prior to taking Police action.

- d. In cases of Agency / Officer generated "hot list" alerts, Officers will utilize the alert to further the operation goals of investigation, crime prevention and/or deterrence.

III. TRAINING

A. Requirements:

1. Officers will receive initial training from the system manufacturer.

Training will include the minimum:

- a. Setup, Maintenance and down-load procedures.
- b. Proper usage guidelines.
- c. SOP review.
- d. Reporting requirements.

IV. EQUIPMENT MAINTENANCE

A. Maintenance/Malfunction and Repairs

Officers will ensure the equipment is in good working order at all times. Camera lenses will be cleaned as recommended by the manufacturer.

1. If a malfunction occurs with the LPR system, the Special Operations Section Lieutenant will be notified.
2. Repairs to the system will only be made by the system manufacturer.

V. IMAGE STORAGE

A. Image capture and retention

Images are captured each time the camera lens passes an object resembling the size and reflective characteristics of a license plate.

1. In addition to the captured image, a GPS location for each captured license plate will be stored.

2. Images will be retained on the server for a period of 365 days.

VI. INVESTIGATIVE LICENSE PLATE INQUIRES

A. Authorization

Investigative searches of captured license plate GPS information will only be conducted for an authorized law enforcement purpose.

1. Investigative searches of captured license plate GPS information will be conducted by the Investigative Services Section Analyst or the Patrol Division Analyst with the approval of the Officer's or Detectives immediate Supervisor.
2. The GPS information will provide investigators with the location, date and time the image was captured by a mobile License Plate Reader.

VII. REPORTING

A. LPR Alert

When a Member authors an Incident Report or Arrest Affidavit that arose from an LPR alert, language will be included indicating that the LPR system alerted the Member to the vehicle/license plate.

1. The Traffic Lieutenant will provide a statistical report to the Patrol Division Major on a quarterly basis as to arrests, recovered property or persons and other significant information as to the operation of the LPR system.

VIII. DEFINITIONS:

A. LICENSE PLATE READER (LPR):

A specialized system consisting of computer equipment and cameras that read, store and check license plates. The LPR is mounted to a patrol vehicle and connected to the computer within the vehicle.

B. HOT LIST:

A list of license plates entered into the National Crime Information Center (NCIC) database and the Florida Crime Information Center (FCIC) database and agency/Officer generated entries for a law enforcement purpose.

C. GPS:

Global Positioning Satellite location.

ATTACHMENTS

- **Appendix A:** LPR Alert Log

LPR Alert Log



Officer: _____

Quarter: ☐ Jan - Mar
Year: ☐ Apr - June
☐ July - Sept
☐ Oct - Dec

Signal:	Date:	Case #	Arrest: <u>Y</u> or <u>N</u>	Property Recovered:	Other (List):
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